ISGS 101 Midterm Revision Session

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Introduction to Aqeedah and Tawheed

- Aqeedah (Islamic Creed) refers to the foundational beliefs of Islam, derived from the Arabic word ‘Uqdah’ (knot), meaning tying or affirmation.
- Tawheed: The oneness of Allah, asserting His unity in all aspects.

- Categories of Tawheed:

1. Tawheed Ar-Rububiyah: Unity of Lordship (Allah as the sole Creator and Sustainer).

2. Tawheed Al-Asma wa Sifat: Unity of Allah’s Names and Attributes (His attributes are unique).

3. Tawheed Al-Ibadah: Unity of Worship (Only Allah deserves worship).

- Emergence of the science of Tawheed: Developed to clarify beliefs as Islam spread, countering false ideas and emphasizing the core message of Islam: Tawheed.

FOUR FUNDAMENTAL PRINCIPLES OF ISLAM



Conditions of laa ilaaha illallah- by Shaykh Haafiz al Hukmi- in sullam al wusool poem :

- **Knowledge**
  - Negating what's negated in shahada- affirming what's affirmed-
- **Certainty**
  - Certain with the meaning- certain in knowledge- no speculation/doubt
  - Doubter is one of hypocrites
- **Submission/acceptance**
  - Through heart & verbally
- **Following**
  - Submits his face to Allah- completely
- **Truthfulness**
  - No lying- sincere from heart- with harmony between heart & lips
- **Sincerity**
  - Actions are free from shirk-
- **Love**
  - Love for people who act upon it
  - Believing Allah more than anything he loves
  - No association in the level of love

Tawheed Ar-Rububiyyah (Unity of Lordship)

- The belief that Allah is the sole creator and sustainer of the universe; nothing happens without His permission.

- Most people acknowledge Allah's role as creator (Quran 29:61). However, clarity on His attributes is essential to prevent misdirected worship.

- Belief in God is inherent in human nature (Quran 7:172). Misunderstandings arise from confusion about His attributes.

- Acceptance of Lordship:

- Recognizing Allah's ultimate control fosters patience.

- Impatience reflects a weakness in belief.

- Seeking protection from anything other than Allah undermines Tawhid.

Tawheed Al-Asma wa Sifat (Unity of Allah's Names and Attributes)

- Allah's attributes are unique and distinct from His creation.
- Key Principles:

1. Accept Allah's names and attributes as described in the Qur'an and Sunnah, without adding or altering.

2. No anthropomorphism: Allah's attributes are literal but not like human attributes (e.g., He sees and hears but not as humans do).

3. Allah's names (e.g., "The Merciful") apply only to Him in a definite form, but not to creation without "Abd" (servant).

4. We do not attribute Allah's unique qualities to creation (e.g., infallibility, omnipotence).

5. Names imply attributes, but not every attribute has a name.

6. Avoid speculative reasoning about Allah's attributes (no "how" questions).

7. Allah alone has the right to name Himself.

We accept Allah's attributes at face value, and remember "There is nothing like Him" (Surah Ash-Shura 42:11).

Tawheed Al-Uloohiyya (Unity of Worship)

- Directing all forms of worship solely to Allah without intermediaries. This includes prayer, trust, love, and obedience.
- All Prophets emphasized worshipping Allah alone (Surah Ghafir 40:60), avoiding false gods (Taghut), and guiding people to live with complete submission to Him (Surah Al-Dhariyat 51:56).
- True Tawheed means trusting Allah above all, not relying on intermediaries like saints.
- Tawheed requires unity in every action, aligning all aspects of life with Allah's guidance.

Faith in Allah implies four things, whoever believes in them is a true believer:

1 – Belief in the existence of Allah.

The existence of Allah is something indicated by reason and by man's innate nature, let alone the large amount of shar'i (revelatory) evidence to that effect.

(i) The evidence of man's innate nature that Allah exists: every man has been created with an innate belief in his Creator without having to first think about it or be taught, and no one deviates from this innate nature except the one who has been exposed to misguiding influences. Hence the Prophet (sal) said: "There is no child who is not born in a state of fitrah (the natural inclination of man), but his parents make him a Jew, a Christian or a Magian."

Narrated by al-Bukhaari, 1358; Muslim, 2658.

(ii) The evidence of reason that Allah exists: all these created things, past, present and future, must have a Creator Who brought them into existence, because it is not possible for them to have created themselves or to have come into existence by accident.

It is impossible for them to have come into existence by themselves because a thing cannot create itself: before it existed it was non-existent, so how could it be a creator?

2 – Belief in the Lordship of Allah.

i.e., belief that He alone is the Lord, with no partner or helper.

The Lord (Rabb) is the One Who has the power of creation, dominion and control. There is no Creator except Allah, no Sovereign except Allaah, no controller of affairs except Allah

3 – Belief in His Divinity

i.e., that He is the One True God, with no partner or associate.

Al-Ilaah (God) means the One Who is loved, i.e., the One Who is worshipped out of love and veneration. This is what is meant by Laa ilaaha ill-Allah (there is no god but Allah), i.e., there is none who is rightfully worshipped except Allah.

4 – Belief in His Names and Attributes.

i.e., affirming the names and attributes which Allah has affirmed for Himself in His Book and in the Sunnah of His Messenger (peace and blessings of Allah be upon him) in a manner that befits Him, without distorting or denying the meanings, or asking how, or likening Him to His creation.

Belief in the Angels

- The word malak (angel) is derived from the root Alaka: Ma'lakah and malak mean message.

- <u>Belief in the angels implies four essential things:</u>

1 – Affirming that they exist and that they are part of the creation of Allah, subject to His Lordship and subjugated to Him.

2 – Belief in the names of those whose name we know, such as Jibreel, Mikail, Israfil, Malik, Radwan and others – peace be upon them.

3 – Belief in the attributes of those whose attributes we know, as we know the description of Jibreel (peace be upon him) from the sunnah (prophetic teachings), and that he has six hundred wings which filled the horizon or the sky.

4 – Belief in the actions which we know some of them do, so Jibreel (peace be upon him) was entrusted with that which revives the heart, namely the revelation. Israfil (peace be upon him) is entrusted with sounding the trumpet-blast (to herald the onset of the Day of Resurrection); Mikail (peace be upon him) is entrusted with the rain; Malik (peace be upon him) is entrusted with Hell, and so on.

- Physical Characteristics

Belief in the Books



Implies four things:

1 – Firm belief that all of them were revealed from Allah, and that Allah spoke them in a real sense. Some of them were heard from Him from behind a veil, without there being any intermediary from among the angels. Some were conveyed by an angelic Messenger to a human Messenger. Some were written by Allah's own Hand,

2 – The Books that Allah has mentioned by name, we must believe in by name. These are the Books which Allah has named in the Quran, i.e., the Quran, the Tawrat, the Injeel (Gospel), the Zaboor (Psalms), and the Scriptures of Ibrahim and Musa.
Those which Allah has mentioned in general terms, we must believe in them in general terms, so we say concerning them what Allah and His Messenger have commanded us to say:

3 – Believing whatever is true of what they say, such as what is said in the Quran, and whatever has not been altered or distorted in the previous Books.

4 – Believing that Allah revealed the Quran as a witness over these Books and to confirm them.

The mufassirin (commentators) said that Muhaymin means trustworthy and a witness over the Books that came before it, and confirming them, i.e., confirming whatever is true in them and rejecting whatever alterations, distortions and changes have occurred in them, and ruling that the previous rulings have been abrogated – i.e., they are no longer applicable – and that new rulings and laws have been promulgated.

It is obligatory for all the ummah (followers of Muhammad) to follow the Quran both outwardly and inwardly, and to adhere to it, and give it its due.

This belief will bear great fruit for a person, the most important of which is:

1. Knowledge of Allah's care for His slaves, for He has revealed to each people a Book by which they may be guided.

2. Knowledge of the wisdom of Allah in the laws which He has set out for each people, laws which are suited to their circumstances as Allah says (interpretation of the meaning): "To each among you, We have prescribed a law and a clear way." [5:48].

3. Fulfilling the duty of giving thanks to Allah for this great blessing.

4. The importance of paying attention to the Quran, by reading it, pondering its meanings, understanding its meanings and acting accordingly.

Belief in the Messengers

1. Firm belief that Allah sent to every nation a Messenger from amongst them, to call them to worship Allah alone and to disbelieve in everything that is worshipped instead of Him, and that they (the Messengers) were all truthful, speakers of the truth, righteous, wise, pious and honest, and that they conveyed everything with which Allah sent them, concealing and altering nothing. They did not add even one letter from themselves or omit anything.

2. Belief in those Messengers whose names we know.

3. To believe that Muhammad ﷺ was the last Prophet.

4. Believe that they delivered the message in full

The tasks and missions of the messengers:

1: Conveying the message clearly

2: Calling people to Allah

3: Bringing glad tidings and Warnings

4: Reforming and purifying people's soul

5: Correcting Deviant ideas and Spurious beliefs

6: Establishing Proof

7: Directing the affairs of the Ummah



The Attributes of the Messengers:

Being Human
Man is qualified to convey the message
Why were the Messengers not angels?
The Prophets were exposed to Trials
The Prophets engage in human Work
They do not have any divine or angelic qualities
Human perfection
Physical perfection
Perfect manners and attitude
The best of the people in lineage
The prophets were free men far removed from slavery
Talents and abilities
Achieving true enslavement of Allah
Masculinity

Belief in the Day of Resurrection (hereafter)

- The resurrection
- Definition of Al-Ba'th wan-Nushoor(the resurrection)
- The resurrection will be a new creation
- The first person for whom the earth will be split open
- All created things will be gathered in one huge place
- Description of the gathering of Mankind
- The clothing of mankind on the day of resurrection
- The land of gathering
- The terrors of the day of resurrection
- State of the people on the day of resurrection
- Intercession
- The reckoning and requital

Belief in Divine Will and Predestination

Definition of Qadar

Definition of Al Qadaa' (Divine will)

The pillars of belief in Qadar

- The first pillar: Belief in all-encompassing knowledge of Allah
- The second pillar: Belief that Allah has written everything in Al- Lauh al-Mafooz (The preserved tablet)
- The third pillar: Belief that the Will of Allah is All encompassing and that His power is irresistible.
- The fourth pillar: Belief that Allah is the Creator of all things

The benefits of believing in Qadar:

- ✓ It is a means of ridding oneself of shirk
- ✓ Adhering to the true path during both times of ease and times of difficulty
- ✓ The one who believes in qadar is always careful
- ✓ Facing difficulties and Dangers with a strong heart.

Categories of Shirk

Shirk is considered the most dangerous sin in Islam.

Shirk in Arabic means taking a partner, i.e. regarding someone as the partner of another.

There are two types of shirk: minor and major, sometimes taking a person out of the fold of Islam and sometimes not.

These are referred to as Shirk Akbar (major shirk) and Shirk Asghar (minor shirk).

- MAJOR SHIRK (Shirk Akbar): means ascribing to someone other than Allah something that belongs only to Allah, such as Lordship, worship, and the divine names and attributes.
- Major shirk may be outward (dhaahir) or hidden (khafi),
- Shirk may sometimes take the form of beliefs
- Shirk may sometimes take the form of words
- Shirk can take the form of actions

- MINOR SHIRK (Shirk Asghar): includes everything that may lead to major shirk, or which is described in the texts as being shirk but does not reach the extent of being major shirk.
- Minor shirk is usually of two types: being emotionally attached to some means which have no basis and venerating some people or things in a way that does not go so far as ascribing lordship to them.

Guidelines to distinguish major shirk from minor shirk:

If the Prophet (peace and blessings of Allah be upon him) states clearly that an action is minor shirk, it should be considered as such.

If the word shirk is used in the texts of the Qur'aan and Sunnah in the indefinite form (without the definite article al-), it usually refers to minor shirk.

If the Sahabah understood from the texts of sharee'ah that what was meant by shirk was minor shirk, not major, undoubtedly their understanding should be considered.

If the Prophet (peace and blessings of Allah be upon him) interpreted the words shirk or kufr in a manner which indicates that what is meant is a minor form thereof and not the major form, it should be considered as such.

1

Minor shirk may take the form of outward actions, or it may be hidden.

2

Minor shirk may also take the form of beliefs

3

Minor shirk may take the form of words

4

Minor shirk can also take the form of actions

Fortunetelling

- Known by various names—fortuneteller, soothsayer, oracle, astrologer, etc.—they employ diverse methods like tea leaf reading, crystal ball gazing, and horoscopes.

- 2 Types:

1. Those who have no real knowledge or secrets and depend on telling general incidences that happen to most people.
2. Interaction with Jinn

- Islamic Perspective





Grave Worship

- There are two categories of visits to graves in Islam:

1. Visits which are prescribed
2. Visits that are Bid'ah (innovation)

- Praying Salaat al-Janaazah (funeral prayer) at a grave is permissible, but performing fard or naafil prayers is forbidden and is haraam.


جزاك الله خيرا